Battling The Heat

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Battling The Heat

by vagician

Summary

> Catra's first heat goes horribly right for her.

Notes

> So, a couple of things. I tagged this fic as canon divergence but it's a really minor one. Basically the only thing that changed is the kiss and love confession being delayed until after the conclusion to season five.
>
> Also wanted to test the waters of this fandom by gifting my first work to the two amazing friends who got me into this masterpiece of a series to begin with. Dragonstone and Miz, this one's for you!

Shit shit shit. Why now?!

Catra anxiously paced around the interior of her quarters within Bright Moon's palace, unsheathed nails scraping a shallow path against the wallpaper as it split around them in their wake. Half of it was to scent mark to gain some familiarity in her surroundings, while the other half was out of an instinctive need to keep herself busy. Adora probably wouldn't appreciate the addition of claw marks now littering the majority of her wall, but Adora disapproving was the least of Catra's worries right now. Not when it felt like her body was burning up from the inside out, the flames as uncontrolled as they were ruthless in their rampage.

There was only *one* other time in her life when she had dealt with a sensory overload to this degree. But that was back when she was still a cadet with the horde. Back when they had the supplements to treat this sort of affliction. Supplements that she no longer had the luxury of having with her. Looking back in hindsight, delaying the inevitable had cons that far outweighed any pros the temporary solution provided her. But while it was in her body's nature to prep itself into finding a suitable mate, it was in the horde's nature to prioritize efficiency in their soldiers over all else. There was no use for things as needless as primal inhibitions in an organization set on claiming dominion over Etheria, even if it meant subduing something as pivotal as one's first heat.

Catra didn't learn much from the staff operating in the horde's infirmary, the doctors there only telling her chunks of information on a need-to-know basis. However, one of the things they failed to mention was the repercussions of delaying a biological process for so many years. Without her supplements to help ease her incoming symptoms, nature was finally being allowed to run its course, and it was hitting the feline like a boulder launched at terminal velocity.

Catra was now totally and completely at the mercy of her body's chemistry, invoking a sense of helplessness that made the fur on her nape stand on end. And that sadly wasn't just limited to her body. Everything around her had her equally on edge as well. If it weren't for the familiar scent of her environment, she's confident that it wouldn't just be the wall she'd be scratching up now.

Switching over to the side of the rebellion was still an adjustment Catra could only process in measured doses. She was already struggling to accustom to her foreign surroundings even before her heat cycle decided to sneak up on her. Now it just made relaxation and any peace

that may have accompanied it downright impossible. How was she supposed to function if even the slightest bit of stimuli ticked just about every nerve in existence? Familiarity was crucial in this sensitive state and everything that lay beyond the security of that door felt like uncharted waters to the feline.

There was no sense of comfort to be gained in coexisting amongst people who had remained on enemy lines for longer than she cared to remember. People who she was still convinced would never be able to trust her even in the smallest capacity. Adora constantly went out of her way to convince the magicat that that wasn't the case but Catra knew better.

Sure she had Scorpia to suffice as another familiar face around here but sometimes the pincered princess could be as equally overbearing as the rest of the do-gooders Adora chose to surround herself with. Even Entrapta found it in herself to forgive her for her wrongdoings, despite the inventor not having any obligation to grant her such kindness.

Catra wouldn't exactly say she felt like a fish out of water since she despised the very thought of anything involving the dreaded liquid, even if it meant applying it to a cliche metaphor. The magicat and water mixed together about as well as oil and.. well, *water*. No matter how many times you try to mix it, they'd never truly be on the same page. Much like the dilemma she and her body were suffering through now.

The only solace she had going for her was the fact Adora wouldn't have to witness her in such a pitiful state. Glimmer and the blonde were already halfway to Mystacor by now, taking a well-needed breather for saving the world they could now truly call their own. Adora fought tooth and nail for the feline to come with her on this trip but Catra couldn't find it in her to subject herself to that amount of socialization.

The feline played it off by falling back on her distaste for aquatic environments, insisting that the hot springs they were using to relax would have the opposite effect on the magicat. Which technically was true. Water stressed the ever-loving shit out of her, but if she were being honest she'd admit there was a bit more to it than that.

The whole reason she engaged with Adora's peers as much as she did was because the dire circumstances around their situation had forced her to. But with order restored and Horde Prime out of the picture, that sense of duty and obligation no longer applied anymore. It's not that the feline was against befriending them, she just honestly couldn't see the point. Catra couldn't just sit around in ignorant bliss and fool herself into a life of happiness she felt she

didn't deserve. Not when the mistakes of her past insisted on weighing her down with enough regret to prevent the feline from ever finding redemption for herself.

Adora always said every mistake is a lesson learned but how many damn lessons did she need to learn to finally get it right? It was just too much remorse to take in one sitting and with her body and mental state now betraying each other, that repressed guilt was coming back tenfold. Suffering in silence seemed like the only viable option now, since any alternative would require lowering down the very walls she's made a life out of building. It was a miserable route by all accounts, but it ensured her misery would continue to remain solely her own. The last thing she needed was Adora fussing over her any more than she already has. She had enough shit piled up on her shoulders without Catra adding several more shovels to that heavily accumulating pile.

No, this was a problem she needed to solve on her own for once. She'd sooner hurl herself into the ocean before ever becoming more of a burden than she already has. Adora wouldn't be home for another few days at least, which gave the magicat at least somewhat of a window to work through whatever hormonal torture her anatomy would put her through.

These four walls would have to suffice as her sanctuary for the time being since it was the only thing separating her from the unknown. Adora was the only other scent occupying this space and Catra had it cemented so deeply within her memory that it may as well have been her own pheromones she was sniffing. The blonde radiated a scent so intoxicatingly sweet that it felt like the only comfort anchoring her to reality.

Now that she thought about it, the alluring scent of her roommate was all she could bring herself to think about, trembling from the effort it took to banish those thoughts from her mind. Catra gritted her teeth, her own thought process betraying her once more as she thought about how blissful it would be to drown herself in that natural aphrodisiac. A scent that was solely Adora. Catra shuddered at the thought, the tip of her tail twitching in irritation before her pacing finally halted. Retracting her nails, she brought her furred hands upward, palms pressing against her temples for self-comfort.

Striving to ground herself, Catra took a deep breath, only to immediately wish she hadn't. The excessive inhaling only granted her another delicious whiff of the aroma consuming her senses, as well as her dwindling sanity. An instinctive impulse had her smelling the air again, letting the leftover scent of Adora guide her to the area it was concentrated the most. Her bed. Or, *Adora's* bed, if she really wanted to split hairs.

Catra had made it a point to make fun of the over-luxurious mattress the minute she laid her eyes on it, she just didn't predict karma would have her desperately seeking it out in her hour of need. Catra huffed to herself, reluctantly nearing the bed. Of course with Adora being the neat freak she is, the bedding was folded to perfection, surrounded by an army of pillows that were equally as poofy as the comforter the mattress was adorning. Catra grimaced to herself. She *hated* this bed, but the love and need for its owner had the feline picking up one of the pillows anyway. Bringing it upward, she buried her face in its surface before drawing in a greedy breath.

Catra was growing mortified at her own shameful behavior, but that self-loathing wasn't enough to stop her from nuzzling into the faded scent of her roommate, claws sinking into the other side of the pillow to hold it firmly in place. It took her longer than she would have liked to acknowledge the deep purr emanating from her throat as her own. As crazy as it sounded, Adora's scent was actually managing to calm her some. While it gave her something to focus on, it still wasn't enough to sate her. She needed *more*. More of Adora. But *where*?

Catra begrudgingly took her face out of the pillow, hugging it tightly to her chest as her eyes darted frantically around the room. What they landed on had her both repulsed and intrigued all at once, groaning in protest as she tore her gaze away from the laundry basket both tempting and taunting her. The feline couldn't stomach the thought of actually going over there but her volatile hormones left little room for rationality. If it was Adora's scent she was after, that basket was the golden ticket to getting what she needed.

Catra, don't you dare. she growled at herself, only acutely aware that her feet were moving with a will that was separate from her own. Every step forward just had the scent flowing in more potent doses, until the urge became unbearable. She knew what she was about to do was unbelievably wrong, but the searing need centralizing below her navel had managed to hurl any and all logic right out the window.

Angrily grabbing the hamper, the feline marched back over to the bed, dumping the basket's contents onto the mattress. After tossing the empty hamper aside and deciding that there was no chance of talking herself out of this, Catra climbed on top of the pile of dirty laundry, the pads of her fingers kneading the fabric to her liking before circling around it.

When she found a preferable spot, she lowered herself down to her haunches, burrowing deeper into the pile. Catra nosed through the garments until she hit pay dirt, her eyes fluttering shut as she let her senses flood with the essence of Adora. It was only when she opened her eyes that she realized the unmentionables she had willingly face-planted herself into. Catra let out a strained puff of air at the panties her nose collided with, drinking in the

scent while slightly cringing at herself for doing so. Why was she doing this? What the hell was happening with her body? Was she really supposed to deal with this urge year after year and pretend it was *normal*?

Catra felt like a victim to her own urges, which was why when she felt her hand slipping beneath the waistband of her leggings, she made no efforts to halt it. Claws now retracted, she took an exploratory dip of her finger, imprisoning the whimper that followed within her throat. Just the minor amount of pressure at her clit had her hips flinching forward, continuously rocking against her hand as she chased after the sensation, greedily needing more of it. Her lips petaled around her finger, the digit now drenched in slick as she let it linger lower, imagining that it was Adora's hand making her feel like this and not her own.

Setting up the fantasy in her head was easier than she thought it would be, considering she actually had a visual to work with this time. Sharing a room with Adora meant she and the feline were often in the other's company, which also meant it left them lacking in privacy.

And that lack of privacy eventually led to Catra getting hit with a view that left absolutely no room for mystery. Adora had been showering, and being the forgetful dork that she is, forgot to fetch a towel for herself. Catra had been right in the middle of dozing off when her ears had caught the sound of the bathroom door creaking open at a suspiciously slow pace, followed by a panicked Adora cautiously poking her head out.

Out of morbid curiosity, Catra had pretended to still be asleep, keeping her eyes lidded just enough to trick the blonde into thinking she was snoozing. Her efforts paid off tremendously when Adora had eventually opened the door, the princess as naked as the day she was born. Catra had narrowly avoided swallowing on her own tongue at the unobstructed view of her figure, the previous mental images she relied on not even coming close to seeing Adora in the flesh.

Catra replayed the memory in her head on a continuous loop, utilizing the visual to her advantage. The unhurried circles against her clit picked up dramatically, the mismatched eyes in her sockets rolling back to their whites. One moan turned to several in quick succession and before she knew it that gathering pressure in her core began to spread downward and out, relief igniting every minor nerve in her body.

A sad sigh surfaced once the haze of her climax gradually faded into irrelevancy, the guilt clouding her mind coming back full circle. She knew Adora could never reciprocate the depth

of feelings the feline harbored for her, but at least she had this private moment to cling to. And for now, that was enough.

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"Ugh, I'm sorry." Glimmer groaned, clutching her stomach with one hand while the other clung tightly around Adora's waist to keep herself from falling off Swift Wind. Now that he had a saddle equipped on his back it made it a little more safer flying at such heights, but the risk of hitting turbulence and getting ejected like human cargo was still ever prominent. Had it been a typical day, the queen of Bright Moon would have just teleported them back to the castle, but the food poisoning Glimmer was dealing with not only resulted in cutting this weekend trip short, but also making it more difficult for Glimmer to handle teleporting at such lengthy distances.

"Glimmer, *stop* apologizing. You're fine! It happens to the best of us." Adora reassured her, a smile etching into the blonde's lips when she noticed the castle finally coming into view. Truth be told, this little outing did little to reduce her stress levels, especially when the one person she's been constantly stressing over refused to leave her room. If anyone needed this trip, it was Catra. But the feline insisted on distancing herself from her peers even when it was clear they only wanted to make her feel accepted.

The two were polar opposites when it came to coping with their feelings. While Adora leaned on finding a shoulder to cry on and letting it all out in the open, Catra preferred to find a dark and secluded corner to wait out her emotions. It was monumentally frustrating to Adora, but it wasn't anything she wasn't used to. Everyone had a right in choosing what ways they wished to cope, even if it meant isolating themselves from the help that's offered to them. Catra was still as stubborn as ever, but Adora could tell she was really trying to make an effort to open up and that fact alone meant the world to her.

"*Hellllo*? Earth to Adora!" Glimmer interrupted her train of thought, giving her side a playful poke.

"Huh? Oh, sorry Glimmer. Kinda got lost in thought for a moment." Adora apologized, mentally chiding herself for allowing herself to space out yet again. The quiet snickering the blonde felt vibrating against her back didn't help much to quell her embarrassment.

"You're thinking about her again, aren't you?" Glimmer teased her from behind, the playful accusation immediately plucking a blush out of that blonde that spread from her ears, all the way down to her chest. Was Glimmer just extremely perceptive or had Adora become that easy to read?

"I-I have no idea what you're talking about.." Adora lied, quite unconvincingly she noted to herself with a grimace. It was no secret the fellow princess could read her better than a book, and today was no different.

"*Riiight*. It's not like everyone sees the glances you constantly steal from each other." Glimmer answered, unconvinced with the blonde's fabricated ignorance. Adora's eyes broadened, only registering one specific detail to that sentence.

"Catra steals glances at me?" Adora blurted out, regret setting in once she realized she had essentially outed herself. Glimmer's snickering continued, the princess wearing a grin that Adora could *feel* more than see.

"Who said I was talking about Catra?" Glimmer continued her teasing, the pink-haired princess barreling over in more laughter when Adora began tripping over her own words.

"*I*-.. I mean I thought-"

"I'm just *messing* with you, Adora. This is normally the part where I'd tell you to relax but then again it's you I'm dealing with here." Glimmer interrupted her, her giggles increasing in intensity when Adora retaliated with a light jab to her side with her elbow.

"Hey, that's *not* true! I can relax if I really wanted to!" Adora stubbornly defended herself, despite Glimmer's words regrettably ringing true.

"Adora, the day you relax is the day Catra goes scuba diving. I just don't understand why you don't just lay it out on the table and tell her how you really feel. Anyone with eyes can see that you're made for each other." Glimmer commented, her words causing Adora's stomach to somersault against her will as it always did whenever Catra became the topic of discussion.

"It's not that simple, Glimmer." Adora sighed her answer, silently wishing Swift Wind would pick up the pace so she could abandon this light-hearted interrogation.

"*Yes,* it is. It's just four words. *'I love you, Catra.'* " Glimmer countered in her best impression of her friend. Adora rolled her eyes but a sad smile followed regardless.

"Four words that have the potential to ruin everything I've worked for.. I *just* got her back in my life, Glimmer. I can't risk losing her.. Not again.." Adora mumbled quietly, her eyes blinking to a momentary close to keep the accumulating tears contained. Glimmer sensed her change in demeanor, her voice softening in response.

"And have you ever stopped to think that maybe she just might feel the exact same way you do?" Glimmer asked, poking her head around her side to try and get a look at her. Adora's instinctive need to remain composed had her turning her head, striving to keep her grief buried where no one could see it.

"You can't know that for sure.." Adora argued, her voice already wavering more than she would like to acknowledge.

"You're right, I can't. And you won't either unless you take that leap, Adora." Glimmer told her, giving the blonde's shoulder a reassuring squeeze.

"I'm going to have to agree with your majesty on this one." Swift Wind chimed in, causing Glimmer to hum approvingly. Adora huffed at them both.

"Taking that leap could ruin *everything* between us.. Sure we've been through a lot already but that type of confession can destroy any chance of salvaging the friendship. If the feeling isn't mutual, there's no coming back from that.." Adora answered quietly, her shoulders slumping in defeat.

"I felt the same way with Bow for the longest time. Just the thought of bringing it up with him was enough to make my stomach ache, but once I finally got it out in the open it felt like

the best decision in the world. Even if it had ended up backfiring, just getting that closure would have been enough for me." Glimmer optimistically responded, silence ensuing as Adora took some time to sit with her words.

"What made you finally decide to tell him?" she asked after a moment, puzzled at the revelation that a small part of herself was actually humoring the idea of telling Catra the true extent of her feelings. Glimmer smiled to herself, staring off in the distance as Swift Wind began to descend towards the castle, the trio only moments from landing.

"When it came to a point where I thought I could actually lose him, I realized that no matter the outcome, it would still be better than going through life constantly wondering about *'what if's*. I'd rather risk giving him up altogether than continue to go on in a world where he didn't know I loved him."

Adora felt herself tearing up at the response, discreetly brushing her eyes with her sleeve before stifling a sniffle. Now that Glimmer had worded it in the way she had, the thought of Catra going on without knowing someone in this world was capable of loving her was almost a thought too painful to bear. If Adora didn't grow a pair and get her feelings out in the open, there was absolutely no chance of ever moving on from this.

"Thanks, Glimmer. I think I needed to hear that more than I realized." Adora hopped off the saddle when they finally landed, offering her hand to help the other princess down, who still seemed to be presently battling her stomachache.

"*Anytime*, Adora. Now come on, I believe you have a temperamental cat lady to confess to." Glimmer quipped before grabbing onto her wrist, Adora's eyes widening in panic when she realized she was about to be teleported.

"Glimmer, *wait*! I still need time to-" she stopped short when the pair appeared outside the door to her room, shooting the shorter princess a disapproving glare. Glimmer simply grinned before giving her a wink, Bright Moon's queen soon dematerializing altogether as she teleported out of the area. Adora could already feel her hands growing clammy with sweat, wiping them on the top of her thighs before shaking them to air them out. Why the hell was she so nervous all of a sudden? She saved the universe from its literal obliteration, surely this should be a cake-walk in comparison.

Come on, Adora. You got this. she gave herself a quiet pep-talk, exhaling slowly for good measure before finally reaching for the handle. What Adora was hit with on the other side of that door was something her future self still could never manage to put into words even to this day. Despite the walls in her room being torn to oblivion, that wasn't the anomaly that immediately grabbed her attention. Catra was curled up on her side, a fortress of laundry surrounding the feline who happened to be sleeping on a bed that wasn't her own. Noticing the discarded hamper on the floor, Adora's expression became the definition of perplexed, having to blink several times to ensure she wasn't seeing shit.

Catra was burrowed into a nest of laundry, *Adora's* laundry to be painfully specific. The sight would have been insanely adorable if it weren't for the flustering sight taking place just down south of the feline. Catra's arm was shoved between her legs, her hand hidden beneath the waistband of her leggings. It didn't take a rocket scientist to decipher what the brunette had been up to prior to Adora's arrival, but it was one simple word the feline moaned into existence that had Adora's heart stopping altogether.

"*Ah*- Adora.." Catra mindlessly whimpered, too far gone to register the blonde's arrival.

"*C-Catra*?"

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Catra's eyes snapped open in alarm, slitted pupils dilating in her panic as her fight or flight response triggered automatically. She must have jumped at least a couple of feet in the air, a distressed hiss leaving her before unceremoniously crashing right back into the laundry she had guiltily been snoozing in. The fur on her tail prickled out worse than a cactus, inflating several sizes from having the life startled out of her. It was only when the intruder quietly began snickering that she identified it as Adora. That's when the dread really began to set in, certain her reality was about to come crashing down around her.

"Bad day?" Adora broke the ice, sitting on the one edge of her bed that wasn't littered with a fort of fabric. Catra felt the air in the room shift when she moved, the scent she'd been chasing all this time enough to make her light-headed now that the source of it was sitting right next to her. It was just one shit-show after the other for the feline, it seemed. How the hell was she going to talk her way out of this one?

"That's putting it lightly.." Catra lowly muttered, her shame making it impossible to look directly over at her. The feline hugged her knees to her chest, her tail wrapping around herself protectively.

"And camping out in a fort of my laundry is supposed to make it *better* ?" Adora amusedly questioned, Catra's ears flattening defensively when she sensed a grin forming in her peripheral vision.

"If I said yes, would that be enough for you to drop it?" Catra tutted, the blonde's coyness just making it increasingly difficult for the hormonal feline to refrain from pouncing the woman altogether.

"You know me well enough to know the answer to that." Adora answered, suddenly sounding more concerned than she did entertained. Catra groaned. Of *course* it wouldn't be enough for her to drop it. It was *Adora* she was dealing with, after all.

"It's nothing you need to worry yourself over." Catra replied. Which technically *was* the truth. Adora had enough shit to worry about on a day-to-day basis without the added stress of needing to babysit Catra in her time of need. Adora's snort had the feline's nose wrinkling in mild annoyance.

"You *do* know saying that tends to have the opposite effect, right?" Adora questioned, tentatively seating a hand atop the magicat's shoulder. Catra briefly flinched at the sudden contact, the feline going rigid as the arms around her knees tightened substantially. "What's going on with you, Catra?"

"It's a long story, *okay*? Just leave it at that." Catra argued, closing her eyes when the curious gaze settled on her became too much to handle. The magicat was never too fond of Glimmer's teleporting ability, or the motion sickness it brought her, but damn it sure would make disappearing a much more feasible process. Something she desperately wished she could do right about now.

"Well luckily for *you*, I just so happen to have all the time in the world." Adora quipped, playfully bumping shoulders with her. Catra bit the inside of her cheek, slowly coming to terms that there was no way of getting out of this. Her roommate was the nosiest individual in existence, and vague answers were nowhere near enough to sate the blonde's curiosity.

"Adora.." Catra groaned in protest, hiding her head when she felt the princess scooting closer to her. Fuck, if her body didn't need to rely on breathing to continue functioning right now, this would have been much less torturous to the feline. But unfortunately she did, and every inhale had her growing dizzier than before.

"You know I'm never going to leave you alone until you tell me, so you may as well spit it out now and save us both the trouble. Whatever it is, we can work through it *together*, Catra." Adora reassured her, and it would have been comforting had the real dilemma she was suffering through not been so humiliating to her.

"This isn't something you can just fix by going off and playing hero, Adora. Not *this* kind of problem." Catra defeatedly informed her, wondering if this was her karma for all the suffering her misguided ambitions had put Etheria through. It had to be, since Catra could envision no greater hell than the one she was experiencing in this moment.

"How would you know that if you won't even tell me what the problem is?" Adora continued to pester her, the blonde's incessant prying starting to tick a nerve in the cat.

"Has it ever occurred to you that maybe I don't want you knowing what's wrong with me?" Catra rudely snapped at her, the flinch she received in return hurting her worse than anything her body was currently putting her through.

"So I take it I'm part of the problem then?" Adora asked, her tone deflated enough to have Catra scrambling to correct herself.

"What? *No*, you idiot. Don't you get it? You're not the problem, you're the solution. And *that's* the fucking problem!" Catra blurted out before she could fully register what she was saying.

"*I-* .. huh?" Adora asked, genuinely lost on where this conversation was headed. Catra huffed in exasperation, knowing there was no other way around it.

"Remember those meds they had me taking back at the academy? The ones I always complained about getting stuck in my throat?" Catra started, mentally preparing herself for the minefield she was foolishly about to navigate through. Catra was too busy glaring at the floor to notice the look of realization that surfaced within Adora, nor the understanding grin that followed.

"You mean your heat suppressants?" Adora nonchalantly asked, biting back a laugh when Catra's head snapped up to look at her, too astonished to care how ridiculous her face must have looked right now.

"What the-.. Okay, when and *how*?" Catra demanded, narrowed eyes looking the blonde over for any signs of deception. Catra tensed when Adora guiltily chewed her lip, her grin now culpable.

"Let's just say last time I was in the infirmary someone ended up leaving your medical files on the desk, and I may or may not have taken a peek at it when no one was looking.." Adora admitted, plucking a loose string from her bedding in an effort to distract herself from the guilt of her admission. Catra was stuck between wanting to be impressed for successfully pulling off such a stunt and smacking her for being so damn nosey.

"And you didn't tell me, *because…?* "

"I figured it was something you didn't want to talk about." Adora plainly reasoned, her grin teasing enough to get another angry huff out of the feline.

"How ever so observant of you." Catra grumbled, opting with abandoning the conversation as she resumed laying on her side, turning to face away from the princess.

"Catra, it's a natural process every member of your species goes through. It's nothing to be ashamed of." Adora reassured her, the irony in her answer getting a humorless laugh out of the feline.

"*Really*, Adora? I'm rolling around like an idiot in a mountain of *your* laundry and it's *nothing* to be ashamed of?" the feline retorted, that humiliation only doubling when she was reminded

where her hand had been when Adora found her.

"Well, when you put it like that I guess it can be a little embarrassing. But it doesn't *have* to be.. There's a perfectly valid reason why you're drawn to that behavior." Adora thoughtfully deduced, unable to see the irritable look Catra was serving her.

"Oh *really*? And what's your grand hypothesis this time, doctor?" Catra asked in mock interest. The question had been intended to be rhetorical, but that didn't stop the princess from taking it upon herself to answer her.

"Well, it's *simple*. You're drawn to my scent, aren't you?" Adora smugly inquired, the question causing Catra's stomach to coil into a knot, momentarily ceasing her breathing altogether. The room had become quiet enough to hear a pin drop, and by Catra's silence, Adora already had her answer. "That's not a *no* I'm hearing.."

"Has anyone ever told you how insufferable you can be? Maybe I like your scent because it's the *one* part of you that isn't constantly running its mouth." Catra countered defensively, despite the blonde hitting the nail right on the head. The silence that followed after was no more than a minute at most, but to Catra's erratically beating heart, it may as well have been eons elapsing between them.

"Let me *help* you, Catra." Adora finally spoke, the feline shivering at what those words implied. As much as her body was screaming yes, her pride was stubbornly screaming in an octave much louder.

"I don't need your help or your damn pity, Adora. I can handle it on my own, so just leave me be, will you?" Catra requested, refusing to let her emotions be plucked out into the open.

"I know you can handle it on your own, but you don't have to, Catra. And it wouldn't be out of pity.." Adora responded, the sympathy in her answer just annoying the feline further.

"How stupid do you think I am? Why the hell else would you be doing it, huh?" Catra shot back, no amount of preparation being able to prepare her for the next set of words the blonde hit her with.

"Well, it's certainly not because I'm in *love* with you or anything.." Adora casually answered, the hidden meaning in that statement finally grabbing Catra's full attention. Retreating from her fetal position, Catra sprung herself upright, finally taking in just how flushed Adora's face had become, the princess nervously fidgeting with her hands in her lap.

"What did you just say to me?" Catra asked, her voice coming out as fragile as she presently felt. The blonde's nerves had an anxious laugh leaving her, prioritizing looking at anything but the fierce set of mismatched eyes currently staring her down. But rather than get serious, Adora began bursting into more uncontrolled laughter the minute she glanced over at the feline.

"What's so damn funny?" Catra demanded, having just about enough of her shit. If this was the blonde's way of cheering her up she was failing miserably at it. Adora's laughter turned to quieter tittering when she registered the offended look on the feline, making a pointing motion with her finger to signal Catra had something on her head. Catra acutely registered the set of undies that had apparently been hanging off her ear the *entire* time, the garment somehow getting stuck to her when she burrowed her head earlier. Catra growled to herself before batting the garment away, her gaze still as expectant as ever.

"Forget you saw that. Now I'll ask again. What did you just say to me, Adora?" Catra continued, a little revolted with the desperation in her question. Adora didn't seem to notice however, having her own set of nerves she was dealing with at the moment.

"Oh, did I say that out loud? *Whoopsie*. Heh, my bad. Just forget I said anything." Adora frantically requested, but Catra wasn't having *any* of it. A startled shriek left the princess when Catra suddenly pushed her back onto the bed, pinning her hips to the mattress before boarding them altogether. The feline tried to put the tantalizing proximity between them out of her mind, staring down at the vulnerable set of eyes locking on with her own.

"Oh, *no*. You're not gonna weasel your way outta this one. I wanna know what you meant. *Now*, Adora." Catra demanded, worried the sound of her heart knocking against her ribs would be loud enough for the other woman to hear. Even without adept feline hearing on her side, she was sure the sound was still condemning. Adora served her that one smile that never failed to turn her insides to mush, the blonde seizing her chin in a delicate grip, using the hold to tug the feline downward.

Catra didn't resist the movement, letting herself get pulled until their lips finally greeted each other for the first time. While the contact didn't cause any sparks to ignite in a literal sense, the feather-like graze of Adora's lips fluttering against her own was more than enough to cause her emotions to go haywire, fingers passively fisting the blonde's shirt to hoist her even closer. Catra was too elated to even bother with getting annoyed at the wry smirk she felt forming against her lips, only halting the exchange when neither of them had any air left in their lungs to work with. Adora pulled back to look up at her, appearing as dazed and giddy as the feline herself.

"That enough of a hint, silly?" Adora teased her, eyes glimmering with mischief as the princess coyly chewed her lip. Catra's contented purring had her body humming in a pleasant glow, unable to recall any moment in her life where she felt as happy as she did now. Had her heat not been consistently reminding her of the ever-present pressure she felt below her waist, Catra would have been convinced she was floating.

"You're such an idiot.." Catra muttered, but her purr continued to betray just how ecstatic she currently was.

"You *love* me." Adora challenged, and Catra nearly denied the accusation on instinct, momentarily forgetting this wasn't something she needed to continue hiding anymore. The feline smirked, booping the blonde's nose with the tip of her tail.

"Oh, *do* I now?" Catra amusedly asked, already having the urge to kiss her again since apparently it's been established that was a thing they were allowed to do to each other now.

"I'd surely hope so." Adora nervously jested, and damn if the little troubled knot of uncertainty she had planted between her brows wasn't the cutest thing in the world to the feline. Catra snickered, catching her lips in another kiss that she ensured would wipe away any more doubt the blonde was harboring.

" *Mm*. Maybe a little." Catra quipped between kisses, an even deeper purr emanating in her throat while Adora's laughter vibrated against the edge of her lips.

"Just a *little*? Not *a- lottle*?" Adora questioned, her question getting a snort out of the magicat.

"That's not even a word, Adora." Catra informed her, contentedly drinking in her scent as she nuzzled into the woman below her. Who was pouting rather adorably now, Catra delightfully noted.

"It is if I make it one." Adora challenged, causing the feline to quirk up a brow at her.

"I don't think that's how it works, loser." Catra disagreed, giving Adora's jawline a guilty nip of her teeth, relishing in the minor shiver it earned her.

"Hey, *who* are you calling a loser?" Adora tutted in mock offense, the princess grinning when she felt a tail affectionately curl around her wrist.

"I'm calling *you* a loser, genius." Catra clarified, resting her forehead against her own. The grin the feline wore must have appeared monumentally goofy, but for once in her life, Catra was too damn happy to give a shit about anything else, her facial expressions included.

"That's not *very* nice of you." Adora teased, her quip ending with a gasp when Catra tactfully sandwiched her knee between the blonde's thighs, the adjustment allowing Adora's to simultaneously do the same with her own. Adora smirked at the feline's brief lapse in composure, prompting Catra to chuckle in return. Her protruding canines pressed into her lower lip, her smile turning nefarious.

"*Oh*, Adora. Haven't we established by now that I'm not a very nice person?" Catra reminded her, a full body shiver thundering through the cat when Adora brought her hand up to the side of her face, delicately brushing her cheekbone with her thumb.

"*Not* buying it, Catra." Adora countered, letting her nails scratch a sweet spot just beneath the feline's chin. Though Catra would never admit it, the feeling of Adora's nails teasing her fur was enough to get a low whine out of her, arching into the preferable sensation. "Now are you going to let me help you, or what?"

"Are you just saying that because you want to get me naked or are you really wanting to help?" Catra pondered to herself, throwing the princess a quizzical look.

"I'd say both but I'm honestly leaning more towards the first option." Adora innocently admitted, her hand departing from the feline's cheek as it slyly embarked on a trip that ended right at the jut of her hips. The hold was just firm enough to be a tease, the feline hating how much she was enjoying this.

"You're such an ass." Catra muttered, the minor smile that slipped afterward suggesting she wasn't as annoyed as she was trying to play off. Catra's eyes widened when Adora's irises briefly glowed a luminous blue, the blonde initiating a partial transformation long enough to utilize the strength that came with it to flip the feline off of her, pinning Catra against the mattress before the feline even had a chance to blink.

"On the contrary. I think you're rather into it, aren't you, kitten?" Adora accused her in merely a whisper, lips taking a return trip to the feline. Adora grinned into the exchange of lips when Catra's legs locked around her waist, providing some insurance that the blonde wouldn't be going anywhere anytime soon.

"I'm *not* above the act of biting you, I hope you know that." Catra warned, but there was no heat to be mustered behind her words. Adora's lips took a shortcut down the square of the feline's jaw, paving a path of kisses that made her neck their end destination. Adora smirked at the frantically beating pulse just beneath her lips, a breathy laugh leaving her when Catra lightly sunk her claws into her shoulder blades, hips twitching forward in a quest for friction.

"Was that a threat or an invitation?" Adora pondered in a devilish tone, making Catra wonder where the hell the awkward blonde had learned to become so smooth with her words. Adora's words carried a confidence that Catra had only gotten to witness when she was She-ra, so this turn of events was a pleasant surprise to the feline. Catra felt the prominent burn in her veins flare in intensity, suddenly despising the barrier of clothing separating her from the connection she craved.

"Definitely the *first*, you perv." Catra started, a gasp fleeing her lungs when the blonde devil grinning into her neck formed a seal with her lips before beginning to suck the tender region in earnest. " *Nnngh*. A-Adora.."

"I'm right here, Catra." Adora whispered into her furred skin, fingers absently fumbling with the hem of the feline's shirt before they descended beneath the fabric, the taut muscles in Catra's stomach immediately responding to the contact. "Tell me what you need from me." she gently asked, the coyness in her tone making the request sound much more like a tease. Catra felt embarrassment heat her cheeks by at least several degrees, the feline still not too keen on the sense of vulnerability she was experiencing right now. She had to keep telling herself Adora loved her and was here to help her through this, and that asking for help wasn't necessarily the worst thing in the world.

"Just keep touching me.." she requested through gritted teeth, having to consistently remind herself not to turn Adora's back into a makeshift scratching post. Adora skimmed the pads of her fingers along the cage of her ribs, but ultimately avoiding the area Catra would have preferred they ended up in.

"Any specific places you have in mind?" Adora inquired, resulting in the feline letting out a frustrated growl.

"Don't ask questions you already know the answers to, princess." Catra retorted, her patience starting to run dry on her. "Just quit yapping and get naked already, will you?" Catra ordered a little too sternly, earning a snort from the blonde.

"*Pft*. Well, since you asked so *nicely* -"

"Adora, I swear to god.." Catra shot her a murderous glare, hoping it would be enough for her to get a damn move on.

"Alright *alright*, I'll stop. Let's get you taken care of, Kitten." Adora murmured, cocking a brow when Catra took matters into her own hands, impatiently tugging her shirt off of her before tossing the dreaded garment aside. Catra grinned at the pout it caused the blonde to sport. "*Hey*, I thought that was my job.."

"You were taking too long." Catra reasoned, giving a single tug to Adora's shirt for reference. "Yours too." the feline added. Fortunately, Adora decided to relent on the excessive teasing for now, doing as the feline asked. She crossed her arms over each other, catching the hem of her shirt in her grip, peeling it off her shoulders at a snail's pace. Catra's tongue thickened in

her mouth as she watched with subtle awe, mismatched eyes mapping every curve of the blonde's body so she could cement this memory in her head forever.

Adora was perfection personified, making Catra wonder if she was worthy of calling such a treasure all her own. When Adora reached behind to throw her bra out of the picture, that awe only strengthened in size. Catra couldn't help herself from reaching out, sheathing her claws as she let her palms run up the firm plane of Adora's midsection, both hands converging right at her breasts as she gently took them in her grasp.

"You're so beautiful.." Catra spoke her thoughts out loud, her tone uncharacteristically gentle. Curious hands thumbed both of her nipples, smirking when it caused the princess to swear under her breath, back arching approvingly at the attention she was receiving.

"Y-You must.. *ah*- have me confused with you." Adora jested, absently grinding down into the toned thigh she was mounted on. Catra gasped when the action caused her to finally gain some purchase against her knee, knowing her leggings had to be soaked to all hell by now. Adora finally seemed to get the hint, deciding now was the ideal time to get down to business.

Ignoring the distracting hands playing with her chest, she allowed one of her hands to lay flat on the mattress, right above the feline's head to hold herself up, letting her free hand descend beneath the surface of Catra's leggings. Catra lost what little rhythm she had, her hands flying from her chest to lightly sink her nails into Adora's hips, striving for something to hold onto as the blonde continued to explore her.

Adora's grin was triumphant when she finally found what she was looking for, the hood of Catra's clit swollen and easy to locate. A spark flared in the feline's gut like tinder kindling a flame, her hips launching themselves off the mattress as she tried to chase the pressure she was feeling, hoping it would increase. Adora's fingers shifted, gently cupping her sex before she lowered herself until her lips were leveled with the tip of her ear, the warm breath that blanketed it causing it to twitch approvingly.

"*Mine*." Adora breathed, the subtle claim over her digging up a whimper Catra failed to bury within her chest. Stroking her outer lips with the pad of her finger, Adora allowed it to dip just enough to gather the warmth that spilled out of her before dragging it back up to her clit to keep both sources of pleasure equally stimulated. Catra resorted to clutching the mattress,

the feline not very confident in her ability to avoid her claws raking into the blonde's shoulders.

"*F-Fuck*, Adora.. Don't you *dare* stop.." Catra pleaded, too gone in her own blissful cloud of haze to worry over the fact Adora had effortlessly gotten her into a clear state of begging without even needing to penetrate her. Adora smiled knowingly, gradually increasing the pace of her circles.

"I didn't plan on it.. Especially when it means I get to see you like *this*." Adora murmured, the sincerity in her words earning the blonde a moan that ended in her name. "All the beauty in Etheria couldn't shine a candle to you, Catra."

"Y-You're such a sap.." Catra half-heartedly complained, her hips finding a rhythm with the hand tending to her, causing her nails to sink firm enough for the mattress to partially give out, the fabric tearing slightly at the strain. The feline arched forward invitingly when Adora grew more interested in her chest, leaving a trail of lingering kisses that ended right between the valley of her breasts.

"Complain all you like, but we both know you're loving this." Adora corrected her, lips veering off their straightened path as they seized one of her nipples, the magicat keening when she felt the stiffened peak get engulfed in a mouth of wet warmth. Had Catra not been so hormonal and needy right now, she would have surely complained at how unfairly good at this Adora was, but she kept those complaints to herself in the hopes the blonde would grant her more attention. Taking some initiative into her own hands, Catra's grip left the bed, hooking her fingers into her leggings and smalls before bunching them down as far as she could manage in her position, causing the blonde to giggle at her struggle.

"Feel free to lend me a hand any minute now." Catra tutted, serving the princess her best scowl. Adora's brows heightened with amusement.

"Pretty sure I'm already doing that. If I lend you anymore I'm gonna run out." Adora reminded her, giving her entrance a tormenting swirl of her nail to further illustrate her point. Catra answered with a desperate " *Fuck* !" that sounded more moaned than spoken, the positive response prompting Adora to repeat the same motion, allowing her wrist to take over with applying pressure to her clit. The angle had Catra's nerve endings screaming in silent approval, her head thrashing to the side as her hips rose up insistently, battling to find some purchase against her finger. Her struggle eventually had her successful at shimmying her

leggings and small clothes the rest of the way down, hurriedly kicking the bunched fabric off her ankles.

"*Woof*." Adora whistled approvingly as she took in the view from her vantage point, her grin growing complacent under Catra's heated glare. "Or I guess in this case it'd be *meoooow*." Adora goofed, struggling to refrain from laughing at her own poorly executed pun.

"Do you have to put effort into being this ridiculous, or does it just come naturally to you?" Catra growled her complaint, her lack of substantial relief making her humor the idea of mounting Adora's hand and finishing the job itself.

"*Honestly*? A little bit of both." Adora quipped, catching Catra off guard when the finger circling her opening finally showed her an ounce of mercy, the blonde allowing it to enter her completely before curling it towards herself in a *'come hither'* motion. Catra hoped the guards monitoring the halls weren't on post near their quarters, since the scream that followed after that stunt could have easily been mistaken as a murder.

Even Adora managed to be taken aback at just how high the pitch of the feline's voice rose to. Enjoying the reaction a little too much, Adora made it a priority to do whatever it took to coax even more of those addicting noises out of her. The princess experimented with positions, partly to find the angle that worked her up the most and partly to allow some wiggle-room for the additional finger she graced her with, making a home inside her right next to the first. Catra sobbed in bliss at the delicious stretch it caused, already dangerously close to traversing the height of her climax, fingers gripping the bedding tightly enough for her knuckles to discolor.

"Oh, *fuck*. R-Right there!" Catra screamed to whatever gods that would listen to her pleas, her toes bending into a downward curl as the storm raging on inside her reached its pivot. Her hips propelled off the mattress, that tightly wound coil in the core of her navel no longer able to hold itself together, the overwhelming pleasure breaking her from the inside out. Adora could tell she was only seconds from finishing, picking up a light thrust of her fingers as she worked her through it, labored breaths enveloping Catra's neck when Adora's face fell against it. However, it was four simple words that would ultimately be the magicat's downfall.

"I love you, Catra." Adora buried the confession against her skin, Catra's lips parting in a silent scream, having no words left to leave her body. Her heels anchored themselves into the bed before her hips bucked upward for a final time, a tsunami of sated satisfaction filling

every part of her body that still held sensation. Adora's hand shepherded her through it all, slowing the pace of her thrusts to avoid overstimulating her. They only halted to a complete standstill when Catra's body went slack, letting gravity take the reigns as she plummeted back into the mattress, a sweaty and panting mess.

Adora gave her some time to bask in the afterglow before gradually disengaging her fingers from within her, wiping the drenched digits onto a part of the bedding that wasn't already coated in the aftermath of the feline's orgasm. Adora stole one more self-indulgent kiss from Catra's lips, the look of adoration the blonde reserved for her being enough to have Catra nearly melting all over again. The princess settled with getting cozy at her side, a bent leg draping itself over the feline's midsection.

"Don't get too cozy, princess. I'm not through with you yet." Catra tiredly declared, silently wondering if she even had enough reserves left to manage parting from the insufferably comfortable bed she was lounging on. Smirking, she blinked an eye halfway open when the friendly threat caused Adora to tense in her arms.

"Relax and let yourself enjoy this, Catra. I'm in no rush." Adora assured her, the side of her cheek pressed to her chest as her ear took in the thrum of the feline's steadily beating heart, providing the blonde a comforting melody to bask in. Catra however, apparently had other plans.

"*Pft*. If you think I'm tapping out this early, you obviously don't know me very well." Catra informed her, her expression softening some when Adora's cheeks flushed at the words, her leg tightening against the waist it was draped over. "And by the way, I love you too. Even when you're being a dork." Catra added, surprised at how easily the confession flowed out of her. Adora lifted her head, her smile saying it *all*.

"I know."

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